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Letter from the editorial board

Dear readers, writers, and friends of the journal,

When I began this letter, I thought I would write about the future. About where we are headed, what we hope to publish, and the kind of journal we want to be. But the more I sat with the blank page, the more I realized that the future is not the right place to start. It is the past that has brought us here, and it is the past that deserves our attention first.

This issue marks the fortieth year of the journal's existence. Forty years is a long time in publishing, long enough for fashions to change, for entire fields to be reinvented, and for most of the people who founded a publication to have moved on to other things. That we are still here, still receiving submissions, still finding readers, is not something to take for granted. It is the result of the work of hundreds of people over four decades, most of whose names will never appear on the masthead.